VIKISEWS

CONSTRUCTION AND DECORATIVE ELEMENTS THAT DO NOT AFFECT THE BASIC PATTERN CHOICE

/MASTER OF PATTERN HACKING/

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Choosing a basic pattern is a crucial step in pattern hacking. It is important to choose the right pattern and sew a toile to check the fit. After that, you are free to experiment and bring your design ideas to life.

When choosing a basic pattern, the main aspect is its shape and silhouette. Such construction and decorative elements as the neckline shapes, collars, closures, pockets, etc. do not affect the basic pattern choice, since these can be added to the design without changing its basic shape.

NECKLINE SHAPES

Top garments feature such an element as the neckline, which can be of different shapes and sizes. Each neckline shape has its name.

When drafting the basic pattern, the neckline shape is determined by two parameters: its width and depth. The neckline width depends on the position of the side neck point, which is the intersection of the shoulder line and the neckline at the base of the neck. The neckline depth depends on the neckline position against the sternal notch.

The neckline can be of any shape depending on the design. There is a plethora of neckline styles and their variations. The neckline shape strongly influences the overall garment look, either being a nice accent or a major decorative element.

Here are the most common neckline shapes:

Round

It is the most basic classic type. The round neckline can be found in all types of clothes, and it can be made on a rich variety of fabrics.

V-shaped

It is one of the most frequently used neckline styles. The V-shaped neckline can be seen in all kinds of apparel, and it is suitable for almost any fabric.

Insert

It is a variation of the V-neckline with an additional fabric element. This type of neckline is particularly low.

Square

A square neckline can be seen in various items sewn with different types of fabrics. The depth and width of the neckline depends on the garment design.

U-shaped

It is a variation of the square neckline. The major difference is the neckline depth and rounded corners, which create a really nice shape.

Heart-shaped

The shaped lines can also be smooth, but still creating a distinctive heart outline.

Boat

It runs along the collarbone line. The boat neckline is usually long and accompanied by short shoulder seams. This neckline style is very minimalistic and elegant.

Plunge

This neckline type is low and rather provocative. It is most often used in evening gowns.

Asymmetric

The asymmetric neckline gives a more intricate look, the garment being not overloaded with decorative elements.

Cowl

The garment pieces are cut in a way that makes the fabric drape into nice soft folds around the neck. This neckline type creates additional volume in the upper part of the body.

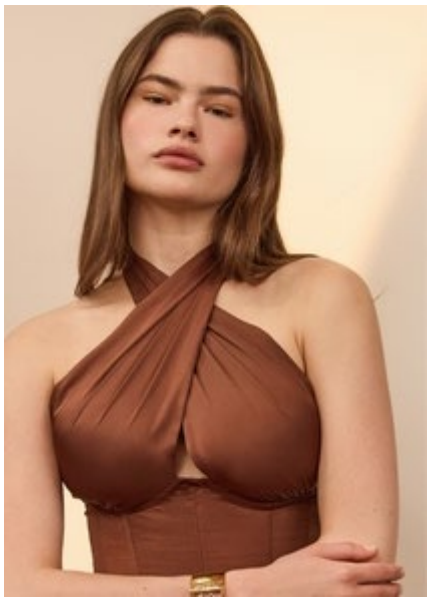
Cowl neckline + spaghetti straps

Funnel

This type has a round opening around the neck, which resembles a funnel.

Off-shoulder

Perfect for celebrations and special occasions, it is one of the most feminine necklines.



Halter

This neckline style suggests the upper back and shoulders are not covered.

COLLARS

A ***collar*** is a piece around the neckline of a top garment. A collar can cover the neck fully or partially, or it can provide no coverage while lying on the shoulders, chest, or back. Collars come in various shapes.

When analyzing a collared garment, your first priority is to check the way the collar is attached to the neckline. A collar seam line is a structural seam which is equal in length to the front and back necklines. The collar seam line can be concave, straight, or convex.

The shape of the seam line affects how close the collar fits to the neck. In case the seam line is concave, the collar is rather loose-fitting. The straighter the seam line is, the closer the collar lies around the neck. The convex seam line makes the collar lie flush against the neck. A part of the collar that fits snugly to the neck is called a collar stand. If the entire collar fits close to the neck, it is called a stand collar.

Concave seam lines can have different curvatures. A slighter curvature makes the collar fit closer to the neck. The curvature of the collar seam line is characterized by such a construction element as the center back collar rise. The higher the rise is — the more curved the seam line is, and the smaller the collar stand is.

Depending on their shape and drafting principles, collars fall into several groups:

Turn-down and stand applied collars for garments that close up to the neck.

A turn-down collar for garments with open center front edges and a low neckline. This collar combines with a rolled-over center front edge, i.e. a lapel.

A grown-on collar, either a stand or a turn-down one.

A flat collar is one of the turn-down collar types.

A stand of such collars is usually small, and sometimes a flat collar comes with no stand at all.

CENTER FRONT CLOSURE AS A DESIGN ELEMENT

The center front edges can be designed in different ways depending on the closure type. The most frequently used styles include single-breasted, double-breasted, and placket closures. The sides of the closure can be positioned edge-to-edge, the garment fronts not overlapping.

A *single-breasted* garment has one column of functional buttons and buttonholes placed in the center.

A *double-breasted* garment has two columns of buttons placed at an equal distance from the center front.

A *placket* is both a functional piece required for the closure and a decorative element. It can be grown-on, applied, topstitched, or hidden.

If buttons are placed in one column right along the center front line, it is called a center closure. And if the garment fastens with two vertical rows of buttons positioned symmetrically with respect to the center front line, the closure is considered off-center. Apart from the center front line, garments feature center front edges.

A *center front edge*, as the name suggests, is the edge of the garment front that features a closure. The design of the center front edge is chosen based on the closure type.

A *front facing* is a main fabric piece attached on the wrong side of the garment to finish the center front edge.

There are a lot of fasteners: snaps, buttons, hooks, zippers. All of these ensure garments fit properly and can be put on and taken off easily. The closures can be hidden, exposed, functional, or decorative.

POCKETS

A ***pocket*** is a construction element used for carrying and storing small things in. There are various types of pockets depending on their purpose and design. Pockets have two major functions: they are used for carrying stuff and serve as a decorative element of apparel.

Based on their type, pockets are divided into set-in, patch, and in-seam ones.

The set-in type includes zippered pockets, flap pockets, double-welt pockets, and single-welt pockets with sewn-in or topstitched ends. Depending on the pocket opening position, the pockets can be horizontal, slanted (slightly off the horizontal line), or vertical.

The patch pockets come in various shapes, but the most common styles have straight or rounded corners. These pockets can also feature a pleat or a flap.

In case you need to add pockets to your garment while keeping the overall look unchanged, opt for in-seam pockets. These are most often sewn in vertical seams, such as side or princess seams. However, the pockets can also be incorporated into horizontal seams, for example, a yoke seam or even a waistband seam on a skirt or trousers. A position of the pocket is the key to its comfort. For example, if the side seam is positioned at the natural level, the pocket might be not very convenient to use. In this case, the seam can be slightly shifted forward.

The pocket position on the pattern largely depends on the design, including in particular the garment volume and construction features. The easiest way to decide where to place the pockets is to sew a toile, mark the pocket placement during the fitting, and then transfer the markings to the pattern.

From the above, it can be concluded that when choosing the basic pattern for hacking, the first thing to consider is the silhouette and ease allowances in the main silhouette areas. Analyze the garment type and properties of the fabric you are planning to use so that the finished item is a perfect representation of your original idea.